

Deep Practice — One Question of Every Real Exam Type

Companion to the recap checklist. Every archetype below is modelled on the real GL Assessment English structure our own mock bank is built against (research/gl-english-question-bank.md) — comprehension is ~52% of a real paper, spelling/punctuation ~17% each, cloze ~15%. Work through each type, then check the answer key at the end.

1 COMPREHENSION — PRACTICE PASSAGE & FULL QUESTION SET

A real GL comprehension section mixes 5 sub-skills, not one: retrieval, inference, vocabulary-in-context, grammar-embedded, and literary technique — plus NOT-questions and "voice" questions on harder papers. Every type is included below so nothing is missed in practice.

- ¶1 The shed at the back of her grandfather's garden had not been opened in three years, and when Elsa finally dragged the door across its rusted track, she was met with a smell of oil and old wood. Underneath a tarpaulin, half-buried beneath stacked plant pots, stood a bicycle — its frame furred with rust, one pedal missing entirely, the chain seized solid. It was, her mother had told her more than once, not worth the bother. Elsa disagreed.
- ¶2 She spent the first week simply loosening the chain, dabbing oil onto every stiff link with a rag until her fingers were black and her knuckles raw. Twice she nearly gave up — once when the rear wheel buckled further under a spanner she didn't know how to use, and once when her brother laughed and said she'd have better luck buying a new bike outright. Each time, though, she found herself back in the shed the next morning, sleeves rolled, resolute.
- ¶3 It was while replacing the cracked handlebar grips that she noticed something odd: a thin roll of paper, tucked so deep inside the left grip that it had survived decades untouched. She eased it free with a pair of tweezers. The ink had faded to the colour of weak tea, but the handwriting — small, careful, looping at the tails of its letters — was unmistakably her grandfather's. *Whoever rides this next*, it read, *ride it further than I ever did*.
- ¶4 Elsa read the note four times before she folded it back along its original creases and slid it into her pocket, not the grip. When the bicycle was finally roadworthy — three weeks, one replacement pedal, and more oil than she cared to count — she wheeled it out onto the lane behind the house and rode it in a slow, wobbling circle, the note pressing flat against her hip with every turn of the pedals.
- ¶5 Her grandfather had died the spring before she was born; she had only ever known him through photographs and her mother's stories. But freewheeling down the lane that evening, the chain finally silent and smooth beneath her, Elsa felt, for the first time, as though she had actually met him.

Retrieval (stated directly in the text)

RETRIEVAL 1. According to paragraph 1, how long had the shed been unopened before Elsa went in?

RETRIEVAL 2. According to paragraph 3, what tool did Elsa use to free the note from the handlebar grip?

RETRIEVAL 3. According to paragraph 4, how long did it take altogether to make the bicycle roadworthy?

Inference (connecting details the passage doesn't spell out)

INFERENCE 4. What does paragraph 2 suggest about Elsa's character, given that she returned to the shed each morning despite two separate setbacks?

INFERENCE 5. Why might Elsa have chosen to keep the note in her pocket instead of putting it back inside the grip (paragraph 4)?

INFERENCE 6. What does the final paragraph suggest about how riding the bicycle made Elsa feel about the grandfather she never met?

Vocabulary-in-context (quote the sentence, then the exact sense used here)

VOCAB 7. In paragraph 2, "resolute" most nearly means:

- A) relieved B) reluctant C) determined D) regretful

VOCAB 8. In paragraph 4, "roadworthy" most nearly means:

- A) brand new B) fit and safe to be ridden C) expensive D) lightweight

VOCAB 9. In paragraph 5, "freewheeling" describes:

- A) riding very fast B) riding without pedalling C) riding uphill D) riding carelessly

Grammar embedded in the passage (word class / clause function)

GRAMMAR 10. In paragraph 1, "furred with rust" — what part of speech is "furred" functioning as here?

GRAMMAR 11. In paragraph 3, "tucked so deep inside the left grip that it had survived decades untouched" — what kind of clause is this (main or subordinate)?

Literary technique

TECHNIQUE 12. "the chain finally silent and smooth beneath her" (paragraph 5) — name the technique used here and explain its effect in one sentence.

TECHNIQUE 13. Which of these techniques is NOT used anywhere in the passage?

- A) simile B) onomatopoeia C) symbolism D) imagery

NOT-question (hardest type — confirm four true things, not spot one false one)

NOT 14. Which of the following is NOT true according to the passage?

- A) Elsa's mother thought the bicycle wasn't worth restoring
B) Elsa's brother encouraged her to keep going with the restoration
C) The note was hidden inside the handlebar grip
D) Elsa read the note several times before putting it away

Character/author "voice" inference

VOICE 15. Based on the wording of his note, which word best captures the grandfather's tone?

- A) commanding B) hopeful C) indifferent D) apologetic

2 SPELLING — SEGMENT FORMAT

*Real format: one sentence, split into 4 lettered word-groups. Mark the segment containing the spelling mistake — or mark **N** if the whole sentence is correct. Exactly 1 in 5 below is genuinely mistake-free — don't assume every sentence has an error.*

Find the group of words with the spelling mistake. If there is no mistake, choose N.

S1. A) It was a great privilege B) to recieve the award C) on such an important occasion D) in front of the whole school. **N** — no mistake

S2. A) The government announced B) a seperate policy C) for schools in rural areas D) starting next September. **N** — no mistake

S3. A) She was definitely B) embarassed C) by the sudden silence D) that followed her joke. **N** — no mistake

S4. A) It is necessary B) to accomodate C) every student's needs D) within the new timetable. **N** — no mistake

S5. A) The committee will B) announce its decision C) at tomorrow's meeting D) without further delay. **N** — no mistake

Your answers: S1 ____ S2 ____ S3 ____ S4 ____ S5 ____

3 PUNCTUATION — SEGMENT FORMAT

Same format as spelling, but every error here is a genuine punctuation-mechanics error (not grammar-agreement) — matching the real exam's Section C: hyphenation, joint/separate possession, comma splices, semicolon misuse, and quotation marks around reported (non-verbatim) speech.

Find the group of words with the punctuation mistake. If there is no mistake, choose N.

P1. A) The rain started suddenly, B) everyone ran for cover, C) except for one boy D) who stood watching the sky. **N** — no mistake (comma splice)

P2. A) There were exactly B) twenty one students C) in the class today D) according to the register. **N** — no mistake (hyphenation)

P3. A) She wanted to join the team; B) but her schedule C) simply would not allow it D) this term. **N** — no mistake (semicolon before a conjunction)

P4. A) Priya and Sam's B) essays were both C) shortlisted separately D) for the regional prize. **N** — no mistake (joint vs. separate possession)

P5. A) The museum's new exhibit B) opens next Saturday C) and will run for D) six weeks. **N** — no mistake

P6. A) The teacher explained B) that "the trip was cancelled" C) due to the weather D) forecast that morning. **N** — no mistake (quotation marks around reported, not direct, speech)

Your answers: P1 ____ P2 ____ P3 ____ P4 ____ P5 ____ P6 ____

4 CLOZE — BEST WORD IN CONTEXT

Every option below is grammatically valid on its own — only one is correct once you account for tense, connective logic, or register. Read the whole sentence (before and after the gap) before choosing.

By the time the bus finally arrived, Layla (1)_____ waiting for almost half an hour. She (2)_____ have taken the earlier one, but she overslept. (3)_____ she was frustrated, she tried not to show it. "If only I'd left sooner," she thought, "none of this (4)_____ have happened." The driver, noticing her damp coat, asked kindly (5)_____ she needed a lift straight into town.

GAP	OPTIONS	YOUR ANSWER
1	had been / has been / was / is / were	
2	could / should / must / would / needn't	
3	Although / Because / Since / If / Unless	
4	would / will / had / has / did	
5	whether / that / because / while / despite	

Word classes

CLASS	JOB	EXAMPLE
Noun	names a thing/person/place/idea	bicycle, determination
Verb	an action or state	restored, felt
Adjective	describes a noun	rusted, resolute
Adverb	describes a verb/adjective/adverb	slowly, unmistakably
Preposition	shows relationship (place/time/direction)	inside, beneath, before
Conjunction	joins clauses/words	although, because, but
Pronoun	replaces a noun	she, it, whoever
Determiner	specifies a noun	the, her, every

Clause & sentence types

- **Simple sentence** — one main clause. "Elsa opened the shed."
- **Compound sentence** — two main clauses joined by *and/but/or/so*. "She oiled the chain, and the wheel finally turned."
- **Complex sentence** — a main clause + a subordinate clause. "Although she was tired, she kept going."
- **Relative clause** — adds information about a noun, starts with *who/which/that/whose*. "The note, which had faded, was still legible."
- **Non-finite/participial clause** — starts with an -ing or -ed form, no subject of its own. "Tucked inside the grip, the note had survived decades."

Common error categories (with the fix)

- **Comma splice** — two main clauses joined only by a comma. *Wrong*: "It rained, we stayed in." *Fixed*: "It rained, so we stayed in." / "It rained; we stayed in."
- **Subject-verb agreement** — "The list of names were long" → should be was (the subject is "list", singular).
- **Dangling modifier** — "Running late, the bus was missed." (who was running? unclear) → "Running late, Elsa missed the bus."
- **its / it's** — *its* = possessive ("its frame"), *it's* = "it is/it has".
- **who / whom** — *who* is the subject ("who rode the bike"), *whom* is the object ("to whom it was given").
- **fewer / less** — *fewer* for countable nouns ("fewer mistakes"), *less* for uncountable ("less time").

Punctuation rules — full reference

MARK	RULE	EXAMPLE
Apostrophe (possession, one owner)	's after the noun	Elsa's bicycle
Apostrophe (possession, plural ending in s)	' after the s	the students' books
Apostrophe (joint possession, one item shared)	's only on the last name	Sam and Priya's project (they share one project)
Apostrophe (separate possession)	's on each name	Sam's and Priya's essays (two separate essays)

Semicolon	joins two related main clauses (no conjunction)	She loved cycling; her brother preferred running.
Colon	introduces a list or explanation	She needed three things: oil, a spanner, and patience.
Hyphen	compound numbers 21-99, compound adjectives before a noun	twenty-one, a well-known author
Quotation marks	direct/verbatim speech only, never reported speech	She said, "I'm nearly done." (not: she said that "she was nearly done")

Connectives by function (useful for cloze and your own writing)

FUNCTION	CONNECTIVES
Cause / reason	because, since, as, due to, given that
Contrast	although, whereas, however, despite, even though
Addition	furthermore, moreover, in addition, also
Condition	if, unless, provided that, as long as
Time	meanwhile, before, after, as soon as, once

6 COMPREHENSION TECHNIQUE — EXPANDED

Reading strategy

- Read the whole passage once for gist before looking at any question.
- Underline names, places, and any word that repeats — likely to matter later.
- Note the paragraph number in the margin as you read — questions reference it directly.
- For each question, re-read only the relevant paragraph(s), don't rely on memory.

By question type

- **Retrieval** — find the exact matching phrase; distractors are real details from elsewhere in the passage, not invented.
- **Inference** — the answer isn't written directly; combine two nearby clues. Ask "what does this action/detail show, not just say?"
- **Vocabulary** — always check the word's specific meaning *in that sentence*, not its most common everyday meaning.

- **NOT-questions** — check all four options against the text one at a time; three will be verifiably true, one won't appear at all.
- **Voice questions** — think about tone across the whole passage, not just the one quoted line.
- **Literary technique** — know the definitions cold (see list below) so you're not guessing under time pressure.

Literary techniques — quick definitions

- **Simile** — compares using "like" or "as". **Metaphor** — states one thing IS another.
- **Personification** — gives human qualities to something non-human.
- **Imagery** — descriptive language appealing to the senses.
- **Symbolism** — an object represents a bigger idea (the bicycle = connection to family).
- **Foreshadowing** — an early hint of something that happens later.

7 CHARACTER & SETTING — THREE LAYERS, AND SHOW-NOT-TELL

Character — 3 layers

- **Physical** — appearance, what we see (black fingers, raw knuckles)
- **Emotional** — feelings, inner thought (frustration, resolve)
- **Behavioural** — actions, what they actually do (returns to the shed each morning)

Setting — 3 layers

- **Physical** — concrete detail (the shed, the tarpaulin, the rusted track)
- **Sensory / imagery** — smell of oil and old wood
- **Atmosphere / mood** — quiet, nostalgic, almost sacred

Show, Not Tell — worked example

TELLING (WEAK)	SHOWING (STRONG)
Elsa was determined.	Each time she failed, she found herself back in the shed the next morning, sleeves rolled.
The shed was old and neglected.	The door dragged across its rusted track; a smell of oil and old wood hung in the air.

8 ANSWER KEY

Comprehension

1. Three years
2. A pair of tweezers
3. Three weeks
4. Determined/persistent despite setbacks and discouragement
5. Wanted to keep it close/personal, not risk losing it again
6. Connected to him — as though she had met him
7. C — determined
8. B — fit and safe to be ridden
9. B — riding without pedalling
10. Adjective (past participle used adjectivally)
11. Subordinate (non-finite/relative) clause
12. Personification — gives the chain human calm, mirrors Elsa's own feeling
13. B — onomatopoeia (not used anywhere)
14. B — the brother mocked her, he didn't encourage her
15. B — hopeful

Spelling (mistake segment)

- S1: B — "recieve" → receive
S2: B — "seperate" → separate
S3: B — "embarassed" → embarrassed
S4: B — "accomodate" → accommodate
S5: N — no mistake

Punctuation (mistake segment)

- P1: A — comma splice (needs ; or full stop)
P2: B — "twenty one" → twenty-one
P3: A — semicolon before "but" should be a comma
P4: A — separate essays need "Priya's and Sam's"
P5: N — no mistake
P6: B — reported speech shouldn't be in quotation marks

Cloze

1. had been (past perfect continuous)
2. could (a missed possibility)
3. Although (concession)
4. would (third conditional)
5. whether (reported question)